



🇪🇸 → 🇫🇷 Day 11 · Saturday, Aug 29 · MADRID → PARIS

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



You: solo · **pure vegetarian** (no meat, no fish, no seafood) **Base tonight:** St Christopher's Paris — Gare du Nord (5 Rue de Dunkerque), 2 min from the station **Veg phrase:** *"Je suis végétarien strict, sans viande, sans poisson, sans fruits de mer."* **Headline:** WanderOn is over. Dawn taxi → early flight → **Only lands ~10 AM** → drop bags → **Musée d'Orsay 14:00** ✓ → Notre-Dame → Eiffel → Seine sunset cruise → **10 PM sparkle**. You'll be tired after 11 days of Spain — this day is built to be doable at 70–80%.

🕒 **WAKE & LEAVE (Madrid, pre-dawn)**

- **~4:30 AM** — Wake. Final sweep of the room (chargers, passport, adapter). You packed last night, so just zip and go.
- **~5:30 AM** — **Pre-booked taxi** Hotel NH Paseo de la Habana → Madrid airport (MAD). ~13 km, ~20 min, fixed ~€33. (Metro is closed this early — the taxi is essential, book it at reception the night before.)
- Be at MAD **~2 hrs before the flight**. Spain→France is Schengen-to-Schengen, so **no passport control on departure** — but still allow time for bag drop + security.

- **Flight Madrid → Paris-Orly (ORY), lands ~10:00 AM** ✅ **booked — QR ready.**

✈️ **ONLY → CENTRAL PARIS**

- **Best: Metro Line 14** direct from Orly into the centre — **~25 min, ~€10**. Fast, driverless, drops you into the middle of the network; change toward Gare du Nord.
- **Or fixed-fare taxi ~€35** if you're wiped and hauling the trolley.
- Buy a **Navigo Easy** card or a **carnet** of tickets at the Orly machines on arrival — you'll ride the metro all day.
- 📶 Activate your **eSIM** the moment you land — you need data for maps, the Orsay QR, and the cruise voucher.

🕒 **HOURLY-BY-HOURLY (real, buffered times)**

Time	What	Notes
10:00	Land Orly → bags → Metro Line 14	~€10, ~25 min
~11:15	Reach St Christopher's Gare du Nord	Check-in is 3 PM → drop trolley in luggage storage , freshen up. Don't wait for the room.
12:00	🍽️ Relaxed lunch (allow ~90 min — you've earned it)	Veg options below. This is a real sit-down, not a rush.
~13:35	Metro toward Orsay	Aim to arrive ~13:50
14:00	🖼️ Musée d'Orsay ✅ booked — QR ready (~2 hrs)	Impressionists. ⚠️ Only today — Orsay is closed Mondays. ~30-min grace on the slot, but aim for 13:50.
16:15	☕ Café rest by the Seine (Gagan's spot near Notre-Dame)	People-watch, recharge
16:45	🏰 Notre-Dame (free, reopened)	Free timed reservation on the app that morning, or the walk-up queue. Spectacular post-restoration.
17:15	💎 Sainte-Chapelle (~€13) <i>only if energy</i>	Right nearby; jewel-box stained glass. Skip freely if tired — no money lost.
17:45	Wander Île de la Cité / Latin Quarter + Shakespeare & Co	Cut first if you're behind
19:15	🍽️ Dinner — or grab a picnic for the park	See food
20:00	🗼 Eiffel Tower + Trocadéro (the classic photo)	Trocadéro gives the head-on shot

Time	What	Notes
20:45	🚢 Seine sunset cruise (~1 hr)	Arrive ~20:00 to queue — Gagan's #1 tip. Book free-cancel online. ~€15
22:00	🌟 Champ de Mars picnic + 10 PM SPARKLE	The tower glitters ~5 min on the hour — your Paris Day 1 finale
~22:45	Metro / short taxi back to the hostel	Rest — Versailles + Louvre tomorrow

🔴 **Protect this core if jetlagged (cut everything else): Notre-Dame → Eiffel → Seine cruise → 10 PM sparkle.** Even skipping Sainte-Chapelle and the Latin Quarter, that's a complete, satisfying arrival day.

TICKETS

- **Musée d'Orsay — 14:00** ✅ **booked — QR ready.** Show the QR at the main entrance (save it offline). ~30-min grace window.
- **Notre-Dame — free.** Grab a free timed slot on the app that morning, or use the walk-up queue.
- **Sainte-Chapelle (~€13) — decide day-of.** Book on-site or skip. No money at risk.
- **Seine cruise (~€15) — book the ~8 PM sunset slot, free-cancel.** Arrive 1 hr early.
- 📱 The only committed euro today is the already-paid Orsay ticket. Everything else is free or free-cancel — miss it, lose €0.

VEGETARIAN FOOD (Paris)

- ⚠️ **L'As du Fallafel (Marais) is likely CLOSED today** — it shuts for Shabbat (Fri evening through Saturday). Don't route to it today; use the options below.
- 🔴 **Krishna Bhavan** (Little India, Rue du Faubourg Saint-Denis / Passage Brady — walkable from Gare du Nord) — **pure-veg South Indian:** masala dosa, idli-vada-sambar, thali, uttapam, filter coffee. Ideal since your hostel is right there.
- **Saravana Bhavan** (Little India) — reliable pure-veg South Indian.
- **Le Potager du Marais · 42 Degrés · Hank Vegan Burger** — all-veg / vegan.
- Use **HappyCow** for the nearest all-veg wherever you land.

TRANSPORT IN THE CITY

- **Metro all day** — Navigo Easy / carnet from Orly. Most hops are 2–4 stops.
- **Uber/Bolt ~€10–15** for short rides if your legs give out (e.g. after the cruise back to Gare du Nord).

- Gare du Nord (your base) is a major hub — easy reach to Orsay, Île de la Cité, and the Eiffel/Trocadéro area.

TIPS

- **Hostel check-in is 3 PM** — on arrival ~11:15 just drop the trolley in storage and collect the room later.
 - **Jetlag plan:** you've done 11 days of Spain including Ibiza and La Tomatina — go easy. Long lunch, café breaks, 70–80% is a win.
 - **Sparkle timing:** the tower sparkles ~5 min at the top of each hour after dark — the 10 PM show from Champ de Mars is the target.
 - **Weather:** mild-warm days, cooler by the Seine at night — carry a light layer for the cruise.
 - **Offline:** keep the Orsay QR, hostel address, and cruise voucher available offline.
-

Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Paris is arguably the most-filmed romantic city on Earth — today you literally stand inside several of these scenes.

Hollywood / French

- **Amélie (2001)** — the whole whimsical Paris fairytale; her café is up in Montmartre (that's your Aug 31), but her Paris is the very streets and Seine banks you wander today.
- **Ratatouille (2007)** — Remy's rooftop Paris and Seine skyline; every Eiffel-and-river view tonight is a frame from this film.
- **Midnight in Paris (2011)** — Owen Wilson wandering the Seine at night, exactly your evening walk from Notre-Dame toward the river.
- **The Da Vinci Code (2006)** — opens **at the Louvre** with the glass Pyramid and the Mona Lisa (you visit both tomorrow, Aug 30).
- **Before Sunset (2004)** — Jesse & Céline walk the Left Bank, Shakespeare & Co, and take a **Seine boat** — your exact Latin Quarter + cruise combo tonight.
- **Inception (2010)** — Cobb & Ariadne fold the city over itself and mess with the **Pont de Bir-Hakeim**, the double-decker bridge right by the Eiffel — glance for it tonight at the tower.
- **John Wick: Chapter 3 (2019)** — Paris chase sequences around the city's landmarks.
- **Emily in Paris** — the Seine, the bridges, the whole postcard Paris you're living tonight.

Bollywood — you'll love these

- **Queen (2014, Kangana Ranaut)** — Rani's **solo honeymoon** takes her to Paris alone (just like you, solo!): the **Eiffel Tower** and Paris streets are her turning point. Feel that same solo-in-Paris freedom tonight at Champ de Mars.
- **Befikre (2016, Ranveer Singh & Vaani Kapoor)** — shot **entirely in Paris**. "*Nashe Si Chadh Gayi*" plays across the **Eiffel Tower and the Seine** — the exact spots on tonight's Eiffel + cruise stretch; "*Ude Dil Befikre*" romps through the streets.
- **An Evening in Paris (1967, Shammi Kapoor & Sharmila Tagore)** — the classic that put Paris on the Bollywood map; the Eiffel and Seine you see tonight are its stars.
- **London Paris New York (2012)** — the Paris leg wanders these same central streets.

Tonight's soundtrack: cue "**Nashe Si Chadh Gayi**" as the Eiffel hits its 10 PM sparkle. ✨

 Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip